Rainbow's End

..A NOVEL..

BY REX BEACH

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"The Iron Trail," "The Spoilers" "Heart of the Sunset," etc.

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The sudden fury that filled Colonel Lopez' face was almost hidden by the gloom. "Yes. Oh, yes!" he cried, quickly, "and you are but one of a hundred; I am another. In my command there is a standing order to spare neither Cobo nor any of his assassins; they neither expect nor receive quarter from us. Now, companero"—the Cuban dropped a hand on O'Reilly's bowed head—"I am sorry that I had to bring you such evil tidings, but we are men—and this is war."

"No, no! It isn't war—it's merciless savagery! To murder children and to outrage women—why, that violates all the ethics of warfare."

"Ethics!" the colonel cried harshly. "Ethics? Hell is without ethics. Why look for ethics in war? Violence—injustice—insanity—chaos—that is



"Why Look for Ethics in War?"

war. It is man's agony—woman's despair. It is a defiance of God. War is without mercy, without law; it is—well, it is the absence of all law, all good."

It was some time before O'Reilly spoke; then he said, quietly: "I am not going back. I am going to stay here and look for Rosa."

"So!" exclaimed the colonel. "Well, why not? So long as we do not know precisely what has happened to her, we can at least hope. But, if I were you, I would rather think of her as dead than as a prisoner in some concentration camp. You don't know what those camps are like, my friend, but I do. Now I shall leave you. One needs to be alone at such an hour—eh?" With a pressure of his hand, Colonel Lopez walked away into the darkness.

Judson and his adventurous countryman did not see O'Reilly that night, nor, in fact, did anyone. But the next morning he appeared before General Gomez. He was haggard, sick, listless. The old Porto Rican had heard from Lopez in the meantime; he was sympathetic.

"I am sorry you came all the way to hear such bad news," he said. "War is a sad, hopeless business."

"But I haven't given up hope," O'Reilly said. "I want to stay here and—and fight."

"I inferred as much from what Lopez told me." The general nodded his white head. "Well, you'll make a good soldier, and we shall be glad to have you." He extended his hand, and O'Reilly took it gratefully.

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The city of Matanzas was "pacified." So ran the boastful bando of the captain general. And this was no exaggeration, as anyone could see from the number of beggars there. Of all his military operations, this "pacification" of the western towns and provinces was the most conspicuously successful and the one which gave Valeriano Weyler the keenest satisfaction; for nowhere did the rebellion lift its head—except, perhaps, among the ranks of those disaffected men who hid in the hills, with nothing above them but the open sky. As for the population at large, it was cured of treason! It no longer resisted, even weakly, the law of Spain. The reason was that it lay dying. Weyler's cure was simple, efficacious—it consisted of extermination, swift and pitiless.

Poverty had been common in Matanzas, even before the war, but now there were so many beggars in the city that nobody undertook to count them. When the refugees began to pour in by the thousands, and when it became apparent that the government intended to let them starve, the better citizens undertook an effort at relief; but times were hard, food was scarce, and prices high. Moreover, it soon transpired that the military frowned upon everything like organized charity, and in consequence the newcomers were, perforce, abandoned to their own devices. These country people were dumb and terrified at the misfortunes which had overtaken them; they wandered the streets in aimless bewilderment, fearful of what blow might next befall. They were not used to begging, and therefore they did not often implore alms; but all day long they asked for work, for bread, that their little ones might live. Work, however, was even scarcer than food, and the time soon came when they crouched upon curbs and doorsteps, hopeless, beaten, silently reproachful of those more fortunate than they. Their eyes grew big and hollow; their outstretched hands grew gaunt and skinny. The sound of weeping women and fretting babies became a common thing to hear.

Dogs and cats became choice articles of diet, until they disappeared. The government did supply one quality of food, however; at intervals, it distributed yucca roots. But these were starchy and almost indigestible. From eating them the children grew pinched in limb and face, while their abdomens bloated hugely. Matanzas became peopled with a race of grotesquely misshapen little folks, gnomes with young bodies, but with faces old and sick.

Of course disease became epidemic, for in the leaky hovels, dirt-floored and destitute of any convenience, there could be no effort at sanitation. Conditions became unspeakable. The children died first, then the aged and infirm. Deaths in the street were not uncommon; nearly every morning bodies were found beneath the portales. Starving creatures crept to the market in the hope of begging a stray bit of food, and some of them died there, between the empty stalls. The death wagons, heavy with their daily freight, rumbled ceaselessly through the streets, adding to the giant piles of unburied corpses outside the city.

Typhoid, smallpox, yellow fever, raged unchecked. The hospitals were crowded, and even in them the commonest necessities were lacking. It is believed that men have returned from the grave, but no one, either Spaniard or Cuban, had ever been known to return from one of these pesthouses, and, in consequence, those who were stricken preferred to remain and to die among their dear ones.

Yes, Matanzas was pacified. Weyler's boast was true. Nowhere in the entire province was a field in cultivation; nowhere, outside the garrisoned towns, was a house left standing. Nor was the city of Matanzas the only concentration camp; there were others dotted through Santa Clara, Habana and Pinar del Rio. In them half a million people cried for food. Truly no rebellious land was ever more completely pacified than this, no people's spirits ever more completely crushed.

Into Matanzas, city of beggary and death, came Rosa Varona and her two negro companions, looking for relief. They made the journey without mishap, for they were too destitute to warrant plundering, and Rosa's disguise concealed what charms remained to her. But once they had entered the city, what an awakening! What suffering, what poverty, what rags they saw! The three of them grew weak with dismay at the horror of it all; but there was no retreat.

Asensio built a makeshift shelter close under La Cumbre—from it the ruins of the Quinta de Esteban were visible—and there they settled down to live. They had hoped to lose themselves among the other prisoners, and in this they were successful, for none of their miserable neighbors were in any condition to notice them, and there was nothing sufficiently conspicuous about two tattered blacks and their hunchbacked daughter to draw attention from the soldiers.

Asensio foraged zealously, and at first he managed somehow to secure enough food for his little family. One day the soldiers seized him and put him to work on the fortifications along with a gang of other men who appeared strong enough to stand hard labor. Asensio was not paid for this, but he was allowed one meal a day, and he succeeded in bringing home each night a share of his allotment.

It is surprising how little nourishment will sustain life. Rosa and her two friends had long felt the pinch of hunger, but now they plumbed new depths of privation, for there were days when Asensio and his fellow conscripts received nothing at all. After a time Evangelina began making baskets and weaving palm-leaf hats, which she sold at six cents each. She taught Rosa the craft, and they worked from dawn until dark, striving with nimble, tireless fingers to supplement Asensio's rations and postpone starvation. But it was a hopeless task. Other nimble fingers worked as tirelessly as theirs, and the demand for hats was limited.

Their hut overlooked the road to San Severino, that Via Dolorosa on which condemned prisoners were marched out to execution, and in time the women learned to recognize the peculiar blaring notes of a certain cornet, which signified that another "Cuban cock was about to crow." When in the damp of dewy mornings they heard that bugle they ceased their weaving long enough to cross themselves and whisper a prayer for the souls of those who were on their way to die. But this was the only respite they allowed themselves.

Rosa meditated much upon the contrast between her present and her former condition. Matanzas was the city of her birth, and time was when she had trod its streets in arrogance and pride, when she had possessed friends by the score among its residents. But of all these there was not one to whom she dared appeal in this, her hour of need. But even had she felt assured of meeting sympathy, her pride was pure Castilian, and it would never down. She, a Varona, whose name was one to conjure with, whose lineage was of the highest! She to beg? The thing was quite impossible. One crumb, so taken, would have choked her. Rosa preferred to suffer proudly and await the hour when hunger or disease would at last blot out her memories of happy days and end this nightmare misery.

Then, too, she dreaded any risk of discovery by Mario de Castano, who was a hard, vindictive man. His parting words had shown her that he would never forgive the slight she had put upon him; and she did not wish to put his threats to the test. Once Rosa saw him, on her way to buy a few centavos' worth of sweet potatoes; he was huddled in his victoria, a huge bladder of flesh, and he rode the streets deaf to the plaints of starving children, blind to the misery of beseeching mothers. Rosa shrank into a doorway and drew her tattered shawl closer over her face for fear Don Mario might recognize in this misshapen body and in these pinched, discolored features the beauteous blossom he had craved.

Nor did she forget Colonel Cobo. The man's memory haunted her, asleep and awake; of him she was most desperately afraid. When for the first time she saw him riding at the head of his cutthroats she was like to swoon in her tracks, and for a whole day thereafter she cowered in the hut, trembling at every sound.

In these dark hours she recalled the stories of the old Varona treasure and Esteban's interesting theory of its whereabouts, but she could not bring herself to put much faith in either. Of course it was barely possible that there was indeed a treasure, and even that Esteban's surmise had been correct. But it was little more than a remote possibility. Distance lends a rosy color to reality to our most absurd imaginings, but, like the haze that tints a far-off landscape, it dissolves upon



Rosa Shrank Into a Doorway.

approach. Now that Rosa was here, in sight of the ruined quinta itself, her hopes and half-beliefs faded.

More than once she was tempted to confide in Evangelina and Asensio, but she thought better of it. Although she put implicit faith in Evangelina's discretion, she knew that Asensio was not the sort of fellow to be trusted with a secret of great magnitude—he was boastful, talkative, excitable; he was just the sort to bring destruction upon all of them. Rosa had sufficient intelligence to realize that even if she found her father's riches they would only constitute another and a greater menace to the lives of all of them. Nevertheless, she wished to set her mind at rest once for all. Taking Evangelina with her, she climbed La Cumbre one day in search of roots and vegetables.

It turned out to be a sad experience for both women. The negress wept noisily at the destruction wrought by Pancho Cueto, and Rosa was overcome by painful memories. Little that was familiar remained; evidence of Cueto's all-devouring greed spoke from the sprouting furrows his men had dug, from the naked trees they had felled and piled in orderly heaps, from the stones and mortar of the house itself.

The well remained, although it had been planked over, but it was partially filled up with rubbish, as Rosa discovered when she peered into it. Only a tiny pool of scum was in the bottom. After a long scrutiny the girl arose, convinced at last of her brother's delusion, and vaguely ashamed of her own credulity. No, if ever there had been a treasure, it was hidden elsewhere; all of value that this well contained for Rosa was her memory of a happiness departed. Of such memories, the well, the whole place, was brimful. Here, as a child, she had romped with Esteban. Here, as a girl, she had dreamed her first dreams, and here O'Reilly, her smiling knight, had found her. Yonder was the very spot where he had held her in his arms and begged her to await the day of his return. Well, she had waited.

But was that Rosa Varona who had promised so freely and so confidently this pitiful Rosa whose bones protruded through her rags? It could not be. Happiness, contentment, hope—these were fictions; only misery, despair, and pain were real. But it had been a glorious dream, at any rate—a dream which Rosa vowed to cherish always.

(Continued in next issue).

Money Lost When Young Salmon Taken

ASTORIA, July 9.—That the fish industry is being injured by the acceptance of young salmon by the packers from the purse seiners, is the opinion of Deputy Fish Warden Larson, who declared that two days ago one purse seiner delivered to the Barbey Fish company a catch of 145 young salmon, the total weight of which was only 435 pounds, an average of three pounds af ish.

The delivery netted the craft only $21.50, he said, but if they had been left in the water two years longer these fish would have weighed fully a ton and would have been worth $600.

Germany s Naval Casualties Heavy

WASHINGTON, July 9.—Nearly 30,000 officers and men of the German fleet were killed and 199 submarines, 122 trawlers and auxiliary vessels and 44 destroyers were lost during the world war, according to an estimate published in the Vossiche Zeitung and quoted in an official report received here today.

"Joy Night at Chautauqua"



The last night of Chautauqua is "Joy Night." It is going to be the happiest, biggest night of the year and just filled with "musical fireworks." Coming as the feature entertainers for this last night is the Earl Hipple Concert Company. Fresh from recent successes on the Eastern circuits, the Hipples are bringing the snappiest, "peppiest" musical program on the platform. Pianologues, violin, flute, xylophone and trombone solos interwoven with duets, trios and ensembles will constitute this unusual evening of music, closing the big week in a veritable "blaze of glory."

DOCTOR SUTCLIFFE POPULAR LECTURER

Writer and Educator Well Known in the West.

Dr. Robert Sutcliffe, writer, educator and lecturer, brings to Chautauqua on the fifth day a splendid, constructive lecture, "Some By-Products of Armageddon." It deals with present day



problems in a sane, sensible manner.

You will like Dr. Sutcliffe—he is one of the best known and most popular lecturers in the West. And his lecture will be good for you and your community to hear.

MARRIAGE LICENSES

Robert L. Wallace, 45, of Portland, and Lucy Alice Fairman, 44, and Nora Christina Nofzinger, 18, Aurora, R. F. D. 4, and Elmer H. Schultz, 25, Aurora, R. F. D. 2, were granted marriage licenses Thursday.

GOULD ASKS JUDGMENT

Joseph L. Gould has filed application in the Circuit Court for a judgment on foreclosure of tax lien on Tract 39, Woodburn Orchard Tracts. The property is assessed to the Salem Trust Co., but is held in the name of Eva L. Swank. Judgment is asked for $17.79 for 1913 tax.

HAS NEW IDEA IN SCULPTURE

Tennessee Girl Uses Dried Apples to Fashion Her Models of the Human Form Divine.

Down in Knoxville, Tenn., lives Miss Isabel Million, who has created a new and distinct art. To be brief, she has developed dried apple sculpture with remarkable results.

For years Miss Million has been interested in the various types of mountaineers who come down to her father's store to trade. Having artistic ability, she tried a good many times to model their quaint and weather-beaten faces by the conventional methods of sculpture, but the results did not satisfy her. One evening, while cutting apples to dry them for the future, she picked up a piece of partially dried apple and noted its striking resemblance to the wrinkled face of the usual elderly mountaineers, whom she was endeavoring to portray.

Taking up a sharp knife, she did a little cutting so as to fashion the wrinkled apple into a human face. The outcome was most successful; she saw possibilities in this newly discovered art; and she set to work experimenting in dried apple sculpture. Little by little she became quite expert in making dolls whose heads are simply dried apples, cleverly cut before they are dried.

Miss Million has found a satisfactory preservative with which she varnishes the dried apple heads when they have reached the desired state of dryness. The costumes and accessories are carefully copied from life; indeed, Miss Million always has some particular person in mind when she evolves a little doll with a dried apple face.—Scientific American.

COUNTY BIDS ON GRADING

The county court attended a meeting of the state highway commission in Portland Tuesday and submitted a proposal for the grading of the Pacific Highway from West Linn to the Multnomah County line, over the new survey.

SUIT ON PROMISSORY NOTE

E. L. Pope has filed suit against Claude Howard to recover $50, said to be the balance due on a promissory note for $100.

CELEBRATED ENTERTAINER AT CHAUTAUQUA

Bess Gearhart Morrison Comes on the Fourth Day.

Bess Gearhart Morrison, one of the country's greatest readers and entertainers, is to be at Chautauqua this year. She comes on Band Day, with two of the most thoroughly enjoyable



programs of the week. Elias Day, an eminent Chicago critic, says: "Her work excels absolutely on the American platform."

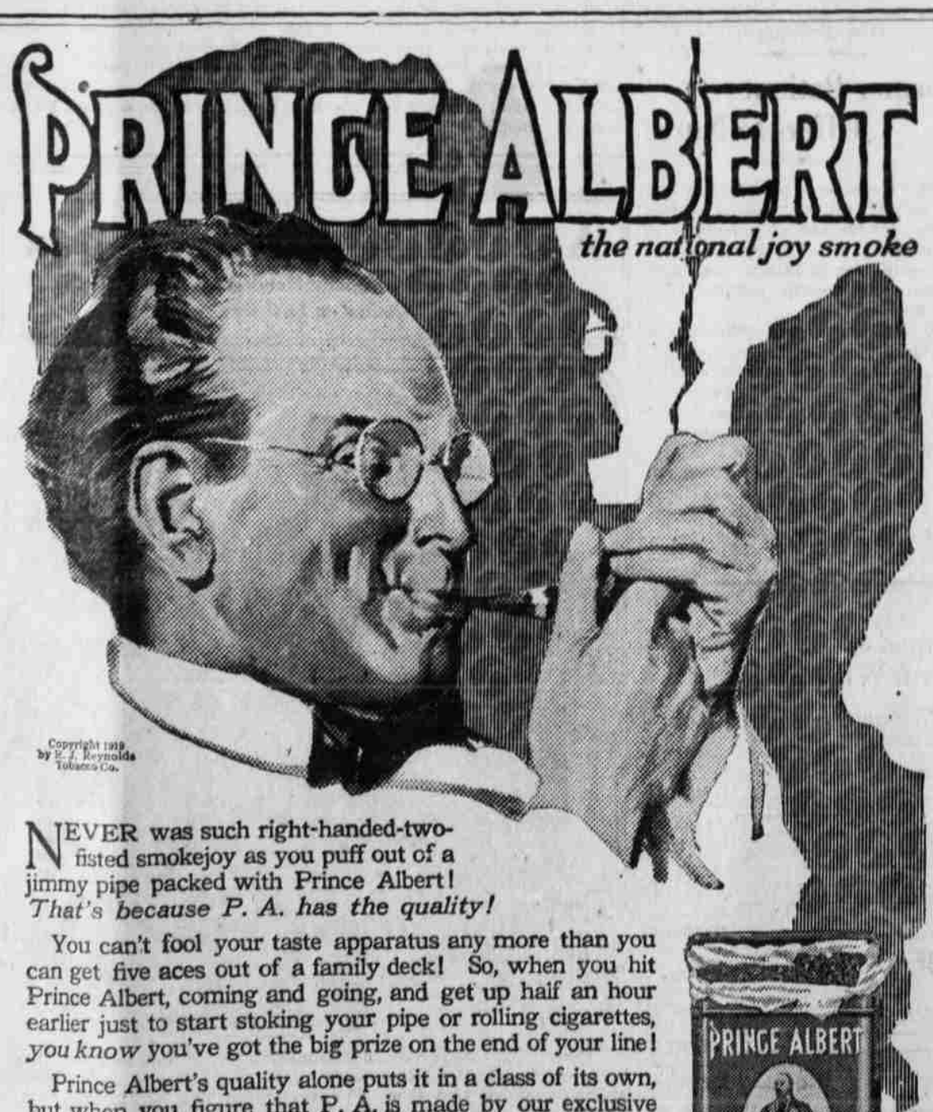
From her "Little Things Out of McGuffey's," the classics of childhood, through a wide repertoire to the thrilling lines of Henry Van Dyke's "Home Coming" song, her readings bear three decisive characteristics: Fitness, charm and exaltation.

SUIT ON A CONTRACT

Adam Kilmer, et al., have filed action against Oliver C. Trefen to recover $1065 or possession of land in section 36, township 2 south, range 2 east, on a claim of a contract of sale. It is alleged no money has been paid since July 7, 1916.

MARRIED AT VANCOUVER

VANCOUVER, Wash., July 5.—Sam Egli, 23, of Hubbard, Ore., and Lela Lowry, 19, of Canby, Ore., were granted a marriage license Thursday.



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NEVER was such right-handed-two-fisted smokejoy as you puff out of a jimmy pipe packed with Prince Albert! *That's because P. A. has the quality!*

You can't fool your taste apparatus any more than you can get five aces out of a family deck! So, when you hit Prince Albert, coming and going, and get up half an hour earlier just to start stoking your pipe or rolling cigarettes, *you know* you've got the big prize on the end of your line!

Prince Albert's quality alone puts it in a class of its own, but when you figure that P. A. is made by our exclusive patented process that cuts out bite and parch—*well*—you feel like getting a flock of dictionaries to find enough words to express your happy days sentiments!

Toppy red bags, tidy red tins, handsome pound and half-pound tin humidors—and—that classy, practical pound crystal glass humidor with sponge moistener top that keeps the tobacco in such perfect condition.

R. J. Reynolds Tobacco Company, Winston-Salem, N. C.

DADDY'S EVENING FAIRY TALE



By Mary Graham Bonner

THE CAT'S MISTAKE.

"Me-ow, me-ow," said Blackie, the black cat, as he came down the walk.



So Blackie Started Off.

"Me-ow, me-ow," he said again. "I do believe I will look for adventures. I do believe I will see what I can see. I do believe I will have some fun and explore. By exploring I mean to go around and see some new place."

So Blackie started off. Now Blackie didn't know much about days. He thought all days were about the same. He knew that each day he was fed at about the same time. He knew that when he cried he got something extra to eat or drink.

He knew where he could chase mice, he knew where he could lie in the warm sunshine, and he knew that if it was raining there wasn't any sunshine at all.

He also knew that on the cold days it was delightful back of the kitchen stove, and that on the hot days it was very nice under a shady tree in the garden.

But he didn't know that Saturday was a holiday and that Sunday everyone went to church, except cats and dogs and very young children. Very young children went sometimes but cats and dogs never went.

He didn't care about doing anything on this particular day but exploring. And it was very early in the morning when the family were all asleep.

He walked around and he ran around and he looked in all directions. "I think I will go this way," he said.

So he walked on and when he came to a church he was hot and tired. "It looks cool in there," he said. "Yes, it looks nice and cool me-ow, I think I will go inside."

So he wandered up the church aisle and he saw a nice place where he thought he would go to sleep. And where do you think, or rather, what do you think was the place Blackie chose for his nap?

As I don't think you will be able to guess right away and as I want to tell you what really happened, I will tell you the place Blackie chose for his nap.

It was in the organ. Well, he had a fine sleep. And he was still asleep when the organist came in and began to play.

Then, poor Blackie woke up with a start! At first he didn't know whether he was having a nightmare or a bad dream, or what was happening.

He moved to one side and the organ gave a curious rumble and a very funny sound and the organist looked as if he didn't know what the trouble could be, and the people stopped singing and then tried to go on singing without any music.

The organist tried to play again and this awfully queer rumble and burr and buzz was heard once more. So the people went on finishing their singing without any organ.

Of course Blackie tried to move when he felt the pedals moving and he jumped over the inside stops and pedals and made these very strange sounds as he did so.

The organist looked inside the organ and saw nothing. Then, suddenly, he saw two big green eyes staring at him.

"It's a cat in there," he said to himself.

Poor Blackie was very much frightened. This was altogether too much. He liked adventures and he liked to explore but this was going too far.

"Yes, that is a cat," said the organist to himself, and Blackie's green eyes shone back at him when he said this.

"Come, pussy; come, nice pussy," said the organist in a whisper. Poor Blackie was so frightened he did not know what to do. Still the organist kept on coaxing and begging Blackie to come out. And after awhile Blackie felt less frightened and the soft whisper of the organist sounded very kind and Blackie came out from the inside of the church organ.



A Little Boy Took Him Out.

Oh, how happy he was when he was out and the organist got a little boy to lift him quietly and take him out of the church.

And what joy it was for Blackie to be back home again, to rest and have a nice sleep after his adventure, which had turned out to be such a mistake!

Gladstone Garage Opens to Public

G. E. Reddicck has purchased an interest in the Gladstone garage, but will continue in his position as a foreman in the sawmill department of the Crown Willamette Paper Company's plant at West Linn.

Mr. Reddick is associated with Ray Porter and William McMahan, both of whom have recently returned from over-seas service.

The new firm is occupying the A. D. Paddock building at Gladstone. The building is well located and is the first garage to be established at that thriving little place.